

CHEATSHEET · QUICK REFERENCE

Lab 25 — Secure Decommissioning and Media Destruction

Work the decommission checklist, wipe media with shred/nwipe, understand SSD secure-erase, and know the physical-destruction and recycling vocabulary.

Wipe media (loopback only!)

```
shred -v -n 1 -z /srv/oldserver.img
Single random pass + zero pass

nwipe --autonuke --nowait --method=dod /srv/oldserver.img
3-pass DoD 5220.22-M

hdparm --user-master u --security-erase NULL /dev/sdX
SSD ATA Secure Erase (firmware)

strings /srv/oldserver.img | grep -E 'pii|cred'
Confirm no plaintext recoverable
```

Physical destruction methods

Method	Notes
Degaussing	Magnetic HDD/tape only - useless on SSD
Shredding	Universal, vendor certificate
Crushing	Hydraulic press, on-site
Incineration	Maximum assurance (top secret)

Decommission workflow

Stage	Action
Verify	Confirm non-utilisation with stakeholders
Change ticket	Open with rollback plan
Final backup	Tested restore + off-site copy
Wipe	Logical wipe / secure erase
Destroy/repurpose	Physical destruction + certificate
CMDB	Status = retired, asset tag returned

Recycling paths

Path	Practice
Internal	Repurpose (sanitised first)
External	Certified recycler (R2v3/e-Stewards)